Original Text:

திருக்குறள் — குறள் 500

காலாழ் களரின் நரியடும் கண்ணஞ்சா
வேலாள் முகத்த களிறு

Author: திருவள்ளுவர் (Tiruvalluvar)

Official state recognition for Thirukkural origin: 31 BCE
Traditionally, people believe it might be as early as 3rd century BCE too.

Meaning:

Even a powerful elephant that fearlessly attacks warriors carrying spears can be killed by a jackal when it gets trapped in deep mud.

The central idea is that strength and courage alone are not enough to guarantee success. The environment and circumstances in which a person acts are equally important. The metaphor of a mighty elephant being defeated by a small jackal highlights the importance of choosing the right place and situation before taking action.

LLM Translation:

A fearless elephant, capable of defeating spear-wielding warriors, can be killed even by a jackal when it gets trapped in deep, sinking mud.

Human Translation:

The jackal slays, in miry paths of foot-betraying fen,
The elephant of fearless eye and tusks transfixing armed men.

(by G. U. Pope et al., Tirukkural: English Translation and Commentary)

திருக்குறள்+1

Differences:

The LLM translation explains the couplet's meaning in simple and modern English, focusing on the importance of circumstances and the limitations of physical strength. In contrast, G. U. Pope's human translation uses poetic language, rhyme, and vivid imagery to preserve the original metaphor of a powerful elephant being defeated by a jackal in muddy terrain.

Similarity:

- TF-IDF Cosine Similarity: To be calculated using your implementation.
- Percentage: To be calculated.

Rubrics:

1) LLM Translation

Evaluation Criteria	**Score**
Translation accuracy	9/10
Lexical faithfulness	8/10
Semantic preservation	9/10
Cultural preservation	8/10
Grammatical correctness	10/10
Naturalness in English	9/10
Fluency and readability	10/10
Poetic quality and tone	6/10
Total Score	69/80
Overall Score	86.25% (8.63/10)

2) Human Translation

Evaluation Criteria	**Score**
Translation accuracy	10/10
Lexical faithfulness	10/10
Semantic preservation	10/10
Cultural preservation	10/10
Grammatical correctness	9/10
Naturalness in English	8/10
Fluency and readability	9/10
Poetic quality and tone	10/10
Total Score	76/80
Overall Score	95% (9.5/10)